

[BEGINNER'S GUIDE]

YOUR FIRST MONTH

What actually happens, what you actually need, and the things nobody explains until you've already got them wrong.

BRAZILIAN JIU JITSU & MUAY THAI
TWEED HEADS SOUTH

MENTALITY



THE HARDEST PART IS PARKING

Almost nobody quits jiu jitsu because it was too hard. They quit before the first class, in the car park, because they don't know what's about to happen.

So here it is. You arrive about ten minutes early. Someone meets you at the door and takes your name. You put your shoes by the mat — shoes never go on the mat, that's the first rule and the only one you need on day one. You'll be shown where to leave your bag.

Class starts. Nobody makes you introduce yourself. There's no circle, no announcement, no being pointed out as the new person. You line up at the back and follow along.

There's a warm-up, then the coach demonstrates one technique and breaks it into steps. You get paired with someone experienced whose actual job is to help you get it right — not to beat you. You drill it slowly while your partner lets you work.

At the end there's live sparring. **On your first night you're welcome to sit and watch instead.** Plenty of people do and nobody thinks anything of it.

THE ONE THING WORTH KNOWING

You tap, your partner stops. Immediately, every time, no exceptions. Two taps on your partner or the mat, or just say "tap" out loud. That's the entire safety system, it's absolute, and it's why people train this for decades without getting hurt.





LESS THAN YOU THINK

People spend hundreds before their first class and then stop coming.
Buy nothing until you know you're staying.

DAY ONE

Shorts without pockets or zips, a t-shirt or rash guard, and a water bottle. That's the whole list. Pockets catch fingers and toes — that's the only reason they matter.

ALSO BRING

Thongs or slides for walking off the mat. Bare feet on the mat, shoes everywhere else.

WE'LL LEND YOU

A gi for your first classes, and gloves for Muay Thai. Ask at the desk.

ONCE YOU'RE STAYING

Your own gi, a mouthguard, and a rash guard for No Gi. In that order.

LATER, MAYBE

Ear guards if you're prone to cauliflower ear, knee sleeves if your knees ask for them. Most people never buy either.

NEVER NEEDED

Anything branded with a fight-wear logo you saw on Instagram. It will not help you.

NAILS AND HYGIENE

Cut your fingernails and toenails before you train. This is the single most appreciated thing a beginner can do — long nails cut people, and it's the fastest way to become someone nobody wants to partner with.

Train in a clean gi. Wash it after every session, not every third. Shower before if you've come from work.





WEEK BY WEEK

WEEK ONE — EVERYTHING IS CONFUSING

You will not remember the technique. You'll forget which hand goes where about four seconds after the coach shows you. This is not a sign you're bad at it, it's what week one is. Your only job is to turn up twice and tap early.

WEEK TWO — THE SORENESS ARRIVES

Muscles you didn't know about will ache, particularly your neck, hands and the sides of your ribs. It settles. Go anyway, move gently, and it fades faster than if you sit at home.

WEEK THREE — THE FIRST THING CLICKS

Something works. You'll escape a position you couldn't escape last week, or finish a drill without being told the next step. It's a small thing and it's the moment most people get hooked.

WEEK FOUR — YOU STOP COUNTING

You know a few names. You know where to stand. You've stopped rehearsing what to say when you walk in. You're not good yet — nobody is at four weeks — but you've stopped being new, which was the only genuinely hard part.

IF YOU MISS A WEEK

Come back. Classes aren't a course with a syllabus you fall behind on — every session stands on its own. The people who train for years are not the ones who never missed a week, they're the ones who came back after they did.





ETIQUETTE NOBODY EXPLAINS

None of this is written on the wall. All of it is noticed.

SHOES OFF

Never walk on the mat in shoes. Never walk off the mat barefoot. Both matter for the same reason — what's on the floor stays off the mat.

TAP EARLY

Tapping is not losing, it's how the training works. Tap before it hurts, not after. Nobody respects a beginner who refuses to tap; everyone respects one who taps early and asks what they missed.

ASK, DON'T WAIT

If you don't understand the technique, say so. Coaches would far rather explain it twice than watch you drill it wrong for ten minutes.

MATCH YOUR PARTNER

Roll at the level of the person in front of you. Going hard on someone smaller or newer is the fastest way to run out of training partners.

LATE ARRIVAL

If you're late, wait at the edge of the mat until the coach waves you on. Don't walk through the middle of a demonstration.

INJURIES

Tell your partner before you start — bad shoulder, sore knee, whatever it is. Everyone has something. Saying it up front is normal, not weakness.

HANDS OFF THE BELT

Not yours to adjust but your own. Retie it off to the side of the mat, not in the middle.





HOW NOT TO GET HURT

Beginners rarely get injured by their partner. They get injured by their own ego, in the first two weeks, and almost always in the same three ways.

REFUSING TO TAP

You feel a submission tightening and think you can hold on. You cannot. Shoulders and elbows don't warn you twice — the gap between uncomfortable and injured is smaller than it feels. Tap.

GOING TOO HARD, TOO EARLY

New people often use strength because they have no technique yet. It's understandable and it's how you strain something. Slow down deliberately. You'll learn faster and finish the session in one piece.

TRAINING THROUGH SOMETHING

A tweaked rib or a sore knee that you push through in week two becomes a month off in week four. Say something, sit out the round, drill instead of rolling. Nobody will think less of you.

FITNESS IS NOT A PREREQUISITE

Turning up is how you get fit. Trying to get fit first is how people put it off for two years. You set your own pace in every class, you can stop whenever you need to, and nobody is watching you as closely as you think.



[LAST THING]

EVERYONE WAS NEW ONCE

Every person on our mats walked in for the first time not knowing what they were doing. Most were nervous. Most had never trained.

Three free classes. Turn up, follow along, decide afterwards. No card, no contract, no follow-up if it isn't for you.

MENTALITY JIU JITSU
7/23 CORPORATION CCT
TWEED HEADS SOUTH NSW 2486
+61 452 518 690

MENTALITY